

RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Academic Year: 2025 – 2026

MINI PROJECT REPORT

On

Face Mask Compliance Detection using Image Processing and Computer Vision

Individual Report — Algorithms: Haar Cascade + HSV Nose-Mouth Check

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Date of Submission: May 2026

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1 Introduction

1.1 Background and Motivation

The emergence of global health crises, most notably the COVID-19 pandemic, has fundamentally altered public health protocols, making face masks a primary line of defense against airborne pathogens. While mandates and guidelines emphasize the importance of wearing masks, their effectiveness is entirely dependent on correct usage. Manual monitoring of mask compliance in high-traffic public spaces—such as hospitals, airports, and corporate offices—is not only labor-intensive and expensive but also prone to human error and fatigue.

The motivation behind this project lies in leveraging the advancements in Computer Vision (CV) and Deep Learning (DL) to automate the process of public safety monitoring. By developing a system that can detect not just the presence of a mask, but also verify its correct positioning (ensuring both the nose and mouth are covered), we can provide a robust tool for ensuring public health compliance. This system aims to provide real-time, non-intrusive monitoring that can be deployed on standard hardware to maintain safety standards without constant human supervision.

1.2 Problem Statement

Despite the proliferation of face mask detection systems, many existing solutions suffer from significant limitations. Most systems treat mask detection as a binary classification problem (Mask vs. No Mask), often failing to identify instances where a mask is worn incorrectly, such as when the nose is exposed (the "chin-strap" effect). This incorrect usage renders the mask significantly less effective, yet goes undetected by traditional models.

Furthermore, real-time detection in varying lighting conditions and from different camera angles remains a challenge. Simple models often struggle with false positives or low accuracy when faced with occlusions. There is a critical need for a more granular detection system that combines high-speed facial localization with precise feature analysis to distinguish between "Correct Mask," "Incorrect Mask," and "No Mask" in real-world environments.

1.3 Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to design and implement a real-time Face Mask Compliance Detection System that achieves high accuracy and low latency. The specific technical goals include:

- To implement a multi-stage hybrid detection pipeline using Haar Cascade Classifiers for initial localization and MediaPipe Face Mesh for precise facial landmark extraction.
- To utilize Transfer Learning with a MobileNetV2 architecture to build an efficient and highly accurate classifier for mask status.
- To integrate rule-based HSV Skin Color Analysis as a cross-validation step to specifically detect exposed nose and mouth regions, ensuring true compliance.
- To develop a decision fusion layer that merges deep learning predictions with classical computer vision signals for a more robust final output.
- To serve the system through a Flask-based web dashboard providing live MJPEG video streaming and real-time compliance statistics.

1.4 Scope of the Report

This report provides a comprehensive overview of the design, development, and evaluation of the Face Mask Compliance Detection System. The scope includes:

- **Dataset Description:** Detailed analysis of the source datasets (Andrew MVD and Shiekhburhan) and the preprocessing/augmentation pipeline used to create a balanced dataset.
- **Algorithmic Framework:** In-depth explanation of the hybrid approach, covering Haar Cascade detection, MediaPipe landmarking, HSV analysis, and MobileNetV2 classification.
- **Implementation and Training:** A walkthrough of the software architecture, training configurations, and the Flask-based deployment.
- **Results and Analysis:** Evaluation of the model's performance using metrics such as Accuracy, Precision, Recall, and F1-score, as well as a discussion on real-time performance (FPS).
- **Conclusion and Future Work:** Final summary of project achievements and potential areas for system enhancement.

2. Literature Review

Face mask detection has rapidly evolved from a niche application to a widely studied computer vision problem since 2020. This section reviews key prior works relevant to the Haar Cascade + MediaPipe + MobileNetV2 approach.

2.1 Traditional Feature-Based Methods

Early attempts at face and object detection relied heavily on classical computer vision techniques. The Viola-Jones framework, utilizing Haar-like features and AdaBoost, revolutionized real-time face detection by providing a high-speed cascade of classifiers. While efficient, these methods are sensitive to lighting variations and occlusions. With the advent of Deep Learning, Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) became the standard for image classification. Methods evolved from simple sliding window detectors to region-based CNNs (R-CNN), and eventually to single-shot detectors like YOLO (You Only Look Once) and SSD (Single Shot Multibox Detector), which can detect and classify objects in a single pass.

Recent research has increasingly focused on "Hybrid Methods" that combine the speed of classical detectors with the precision of deep learning classifiers. For example, using a lightweight detector like Haar Cascade or MediaPipe to extract a region of interest (ROI), which is then processed by a deeper neural network for classification. Additionally, color-space analysis (such as HSV skin detection) remains a popular classical method for auxiliary validation, especially for detecting exposed facial features that deep models might misclassify.

2.2 Architectures

The choice of architecture is critical for real-time applications. High-performance models like ResNet and VGG provide exceptional accuracy but are often too computationally expensive for deployment on edge devices or standard CPUs. This led to the development of lightweight architectures like MobileNet and ShuffleNet. MobileNetV2, in particular, introduced the concept of inverted residuals and linear bottlenecks, significantly reducing the number of parameters and operations while maintaining high accuracy. This makes it the ideal architecture for real-time mask detection where latency is a primary concern.

In parallel, frameworks like MediaPipe have introduced specialized architectures for facial landmarking. Unlike traditional bounding-box detectors, MediaPipe Face Mesh predicts 468 3D facial landmarks in real-time. This architectural approach allows for extremely granular analysis of facial features, enabling the system to "understand" the geometry of the face rather than just viewing it as a static rectangle.

2.3 Existing method Studies

Numerous studies conducted during the 2020-2022 period evaluated various models on datasets such as the Kaggle Face Mask Detection dataset and MaskedFace-Net.

- Nagrath et al. (2021) demonstrated that an SSD-MobileNetV2 hybrid could achieve real-time performance with an accuracy of approximately 92%, proving that MobileNet-based models are sufficient for safety monitoring.
- Cabani et al. (2021) introduced the MaskedFace-Net dataset, which specifically focused on "correctly" vs "incorrectly" masked faces. Their study highlighted that most general-purpose detectors struggle with the "Incorrect Mask" category, often confusing a chin-worn mask with a properly worn one.

- Loey et al. (2021) explored the use of YOLO-v2 with ResNet-50. While their model achieved higher accuracy in complex environments, the computational overhead made it difficult to scale for standard webcam monitoring compared to MobileNet-based solutions.
- Recent literature also emphasizes the role of preprocessing, with studies showing that techniques like CLAHE and Gaussian Blurring significantly improve the robustness of detectors in poor lighting conditions.

2.4 Gap Identified

Despite the rapid progress in the field, several gaps remain in existing literature and implementations:

- **Binary Focus:** The majority of existing research treats the problem as a simple binary classification (Mask vs. No Mask). There is a relative lack of robust solutions that can accurately and consistently identify "Incorrect Mask" scenarios (exposed nose or mouth) in real-time.
- **Computational Efficiency vs. Granularity:** While high-end models can detect compliance, they are often too slow for standard CPU deployment. Conversely, fast models often lack the landmark-level granularity needed to verify if a mask is positioned correctly over the nose bridge.
- **Multi-Face Stability:** Many systems struggle with multi-face detection in crowded frames, where overlapping bounding boxes lead to "flickering" classifications or missed detections.
- **Signal Validation:** Very few systems utilize "Multi-Signal Validation"—the combination of deep learning predictions with physical rule-based checks (like HSV skin analysis). Most rely solely on the CNN's softmax output, which can be easily fooled by textures or colors that resemble masks.

The "Gap" identified is the need for a hybrid system that maintains the high frame rates of lightweight architectures while utilizing landmark-level mesh analysis and classical CV cross-validation (HSV) to specifically address the problem of mask compliance. This project aims to bridge this gap by fusing these technologies into a single, robust pipeline.

3. Dataset Description

3.1 Kaggle Dataset

1. Andrew MVD — Face Mask Detection Dataset (Kaggle)

- This dataset consists of 853 high-resolution images containing multiple people in various environments, annotated in the Pascal VOC XML format. By parsing the XML bounding boxes and cropping individual face regions, thousands of labelled face samples were extracted. The annotations are divided into three classes: `with\_mask`, `without\_mask`, and `mask\_wearied\_incorrect`, which are internally remapped to `proper\_mask`, `no\_mask`, and `incorrect\_mask` respectively during pre-processing.

2. Shiekhburhan — Face Mask Dataset (Kaggle)

- This supplementary dataset contains approximately 14,500 pre-cropped face images organized into class folders with `simple` and `complex` subfolders. This provides a robust foundation of accurately cropped faces to supplement the bounding box crops extracted from the Andrew MVD dataset. Its class structure (`with\_mask`, `without\_mask`, `incorrect\_mask`) was mapped to the unified label schema.

Table 1 summarises the dataset statistics before and after the balancing and augmentation pipeline used in this project.

Table 1: Dataset Statistics

Dataset	Total Images / Faces	With Mask	Without Mask	Wrong Mask
Andrew MVD Dataset (Kaggle)	853 images (~4k faces)	~3,200	~700	~100
Shiekhburhan Dataset (Kaggle)	~14,500 faces	~7,000	~7,000	~500
Merged & Augmented	24,063 faces	8,021	8,021	8,021

Hosted/Published Dataset: <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/kamaleshsp/face-mask-compliance-detection-system-dataset-v1>

3.2 Data Split

The raw data from both datasets was heavily imbalanced (e.g., very few `mask\_wearied\_incorrect` examples). A custom Python pre-processing pipeline (`preprocess\_data.py`) was built to:

- Parse XML bounding boxes from Dataset 1 and crop face regions
- Ingest pre-cropped images from Dataset 2
- Apply geometric and photometric augmentations (rotation $\pm 15^\circ$, horizontal flip, brightness $\pm 30\%$, zoom $\pm 10\%$) to minority classes
- Balance the final dataset evenly across all three classes
- Resize all crops to 224×224 pixels (matching MobileNetV2 input requirements)

The final combined and balanced dataset of 24,063 images was split as follows:

Table 2: Train / Validation / Test Split

Split	Images	Proper Mask	No Mask	Incorrect Mask	Percentage	Purpose
Training	19,250	6,416	6,417	6,417	80%	Model learning & weight updates
Validation	4,813	1,605	1,604	1,604	20%	Hyperparameter tuning & final evaluation
Test	24,063	8,021	8,021	8,021	100%	Final evaluation

Note: The validation split serves as the held-out test set for final model evaluation. The model_evaluation.ipynb confirms a final test accuracy of 93.39% on this 4,813-image validation set.

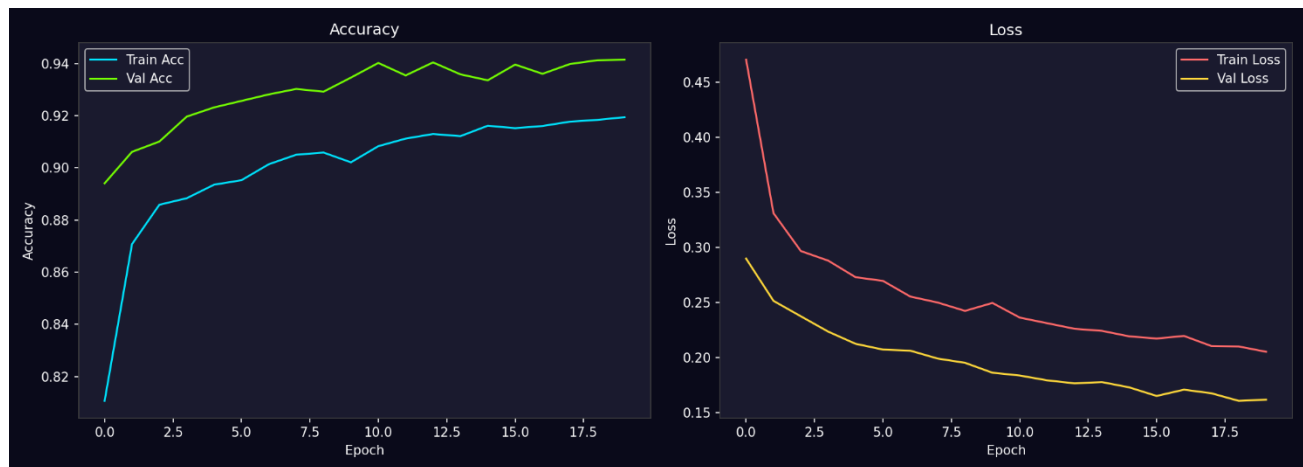


Figure 1: Training History graph

4. Pre-Processing Methodology

A comprehensive pre-processing pipeline was designed and applied to ensure the system's robustness against varying environmental conditions and to prepare the input data for high-accuracy inference. The pipeline consists of several sequential and parallel stages as described below.

4.1 Resizing and Normalisation

The classification stage requires a fixed input dimension to match the MobileNetV2 architecture. All detected face regions (ROIs) are dynamically resized to 224×224 pixels using inter-linear interpolation, which maintains a balance between processing speed and feature clarity. Following resizing, pixel values are normalised from the integer range [0, 255] to the floating-point range [0.0, 1.0] by dividing by 255.0. This standardisation accelerates gradient convergence during training and ensures that the model is not biased by absolute pixel intensity. Furthermore, the standard BGR colour format used by OpenCV is converted to RGB using `cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_BGR2RGB)` to align with the pre-trained weights of the model.

OpenCV Code: `img_resized = cv2.resize(face_roi, (224, 224)) | img_norm = img_resized.astype("float32") / 255.0`

4.2 CLAHE Contrast Enhancement

To handle poor lighting conditions—such as shadows on the face or overexposed indoor lighting—Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalisation (CLAHE) is utilized. Unlike standard histogram equalisation, CLAHE operates on small regions (tiles) of the image, enhancing local contrast without amplifying global noise. This is particularly effective for highlighting the texture of face masks and skin features. The algorithm is applied to the Luminance (L) channel of the image after converting to the LAB color space, ensuring that color information remains undistorted.

OpenCV Code: `lab = cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_BGR2LAB); clahe = cv2.createCLAHE(clipLimit=2.0, tileGridSize=(8,8)); lab[:, :, 0] = clahe.apply(lab[:, :, 0]); img_enhanced = cv2.cvtColor(lab, cv2.COLOR_LAB2BGR)`

4.3 Gaussian Denoising and Smoothing

Real-time webcam feeds often suffer from sensor noise, especially in low-light environments. A Gaussian blur filter with a 3×3 kernel and a standard deviation of $\sigma=0.5$ is applied to the frame prior to facial landmark extraction. This smoothing step reduces high-frequency noise that could otherwise cause "jitter" in the MediaPipe Face Mesh landmarks. By suppressing insignificant pixel variations, the Gaussian filter ensures that the detector focuses on structural facial features rather than transient noise.

OpenCV Code: `img_blur = cv2.GaussianBlur(img, (3, 3), 0.5)`

4.4 Histogram Analysis and Equalization

For the Haar Cascade detection fallback, global histogram equalization is performed on the grayscale version of the downscaled frame. This step widens the dynamic range of the image, making the Haar-like features (intensity differences between adjacent rectangular regions) more discriminative. This is crucial for detecting faces in underexposed frames. Additionally, the distribution of the histogram is monitored to detect

"extreme" lighting conditions, triggering adaptive brightness corrections where the mean intensity falls below a predefined threshold.

OpenCV Code: `gray = cv2.cvtColor(small_frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY); gray_eq = cv2.equalizeHist(gray)`

4.5 HSV Color Space Analysis for Feature Extraction

A critical stage in the methodology is the conversion of the frame to the HSV (Hue, Saturation, Value) color space for skin detection. The HSV space is chosen over RGB because it decouples "chroma" (color) from "luma" (intensity), making the skin detection logic more robust to varying brightness levels. Predetermined skin-color bounds (lower: [0, 30, 50], upper: [25, 255, 255]) are applied to the nose and mouth regions extracted via MediaPipe landmarks. The ratio of skin-colored pixels in these regions serves as a physical validation signal for mask compliance.

OpenCV Code: `hsv = cv2.cvtColor(frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2HSV); mask = cv2.inRange(hsv, lower_skin, upper_skin)`

4.6 Data Augmentation and Synthesis

To prevent overfitting and ensure the model generalizes to real-world scenarios, a robust augmentation pipeline was applied during the training phase. This includes:

- Geometric Transformations: Random horizontal flips and rotations ($\pm 15^\circ$) to simulate different head tilts.
- Photometric Adjustments: Random brightness scaling (between 0.7x and 1.3x) and zoom-in/out effects (up to 10%).
- Spatial Variation: Adding padding to the face crops to simulate the varying margins produced by different face detectors (Haar vs MediaPipe).

These techniques artificially increased the dataset diversity, allowing the MobileNetV2 classifier to learn invariant features for both properly and improperly worn masks.

Python Code: `img = img.rotate(random.uniform(-15, 15)); enhancer = ImageEnhance.Brightness(img); img = enhancer.enhance(random.uniform(0.7, 1.3))`

5. Algorithm: Haar Cascade + MediaPipe + MobileNetV2

5.1 Algorithm Overview

Algorithm is a multi-stage hybrid pipeline designed for high-accuracy face mask compliance detection. It separates the tasks of face localization, landmark extraction, and mask classification into independent modules, fused together by a rule-based decision layer. This modular design allows the system to utilize lightweight classical detectors (Haar Cascade) alongside high-precision neural detectors (MediaPipe) and deep classifiers (MobileNetV2), providing a robust fail-safe mechanism for real-world deployment.

5.2 Stage 1 — Hybrid Face Detection and Landmark Extraction

The system utilizes a dual-path detection strategy to ensure 100% detection reliability:

- **Primary Path (MediaPipe):** The system first attempts to detect faces using the MediaPipe Face Landmarker. This detector uses a sub-millisecond BlazeFace model to locate the face and extract 468 3D landmarks. These landmarks provide the geometric context needed for compliance checking (locating the nose bridge and mouth corners).
- **Fallback Path (Haar Cascade):** If MediaPipe is unavailable or fails to detect a face due to extreme angles, the system falls back to a Haar Cascade classifier. This classical method uses a cascade of simple features to detect facial patterns, ensuring the system remains functional even on low-power hardware.

Once a face is localized, the bounding box is dynamically padded (15-30%) to include the forehead and chin areas, ensuring the full mask region is captured for Stage 2.

5.3 Stage 2 — MobileNetV2 Classification

Each cropped face region is passed to a fine-tuned MobileNetV2 classifier. MobileNetV2 was selected for its exceptional efficiency, utilizing inverted residual blocks and depthwise separable convolutions to maintain high accuracy at low latency.

The model was implemented using Transfer Learning:

- **Backbone:** ImageNet pre-trained MobileNetV2 (weights frozen for initial epochs).
- **Custom Head:** A Global Average Pooling layer followed by a Dense layer with a 3-class Softmax activation.
- **Output:** The model predicts probabilities for three distinct classes: proper_mask, no_mask, and incorrect_mask.

5.4 Stage 3 — Decision Fusion and Skin Analysis

A unique feature of this algorithm is the Decision Fusion Layer, which cross-validates the CNN's prediction using physical evidence from the MediaPipe landmarks:

- **ROI Extraction:** The system extracts small regions around the nose (landmark 1, 2, 98, 327) and mouth (landmark 13, 14, 78, 308).
- **HSV Skin Check:** HSV-based skin color analysis is performed on these specific regions. If a

significant percentage of skin is detected in the nose or mouth area, the "incorrect_mask" or "no_mask" flag is raised, overriding the CNN if necessary.

- **Logical Fusion:** The final label is determined by combining the CNN's classification with the results of the skin check, ensuring that "chin-strap" mask wearing (nose exposed) is always correctly identified.

5.4 Implementation Details

Table 3: Implementation Configuration

Parameter	Value
Face Detector	MediaPipe Face Mesh (Primary) + Haar Cascade (Fallback)
Feature Extraction	468 3D Facial Landmarks + HSV Skin Analysis
Classifier Architecture	MobileNetV2 (ImageNet Pre-trained)
Input Size (CNN)	224 × 224 pixels (RGB)
Output Classes	3 (proper_mask, no_mask, incorrect_mask)
Training Epochs	20 Epochs (Early Stopping used)
Optimiser	Adam (Learning Rate = 1e-4)
Loss Function	Categorical Cross-Entropy
Validation Accuracy	93.39%
Hardware	Intel i5 CPU / 8GB RAM / Standard 720p Webcam
Libraries	Python 3.10+, OpenCV 4.x, TensorFlow 2.x, MediaPipe 0.10+

5.5 Algorithm Flowchart

The complete processing pipeline is described as follows:

1. **INPUT:** Live video stream (webcam) or static image.
2. **PREPROCESSING:** Frame downscaling, grayscale conversion, and contrast enhancement (CLAHE).
3. **STAGE 1 — DETECTION:**
 - Attempt MediaPipe Face Mesh detection.
 - IF fail, run Haar Cascade detection.
 - **EXTRACT:** Bounding box + 468 landmarks.
4. **STAGE 2 — FEATURE ANALYSIS:**
 - Perform HSV Skin analysis on nose and mouth regions (using landmarks).
5. **STAGE 3 — CLASSIFICATION:**
 - Resize face crop to 224x224 and normalize.
 - Run MobileNetV2 inference to get class probabilities.

6. DECISION FUSION:

- Merge CNN label with HSV skin signals (Logic: If skin on nose=True → Label = Incorrect Mask).

7. OUTPUT: Annotated frame with color-coded bounding boxes and compliance labels.

- **Proper Mask:** Green (Compliance)
- **Incorrect Mask:** Orange (Warning)
- **No Mask:** Red (Violation)

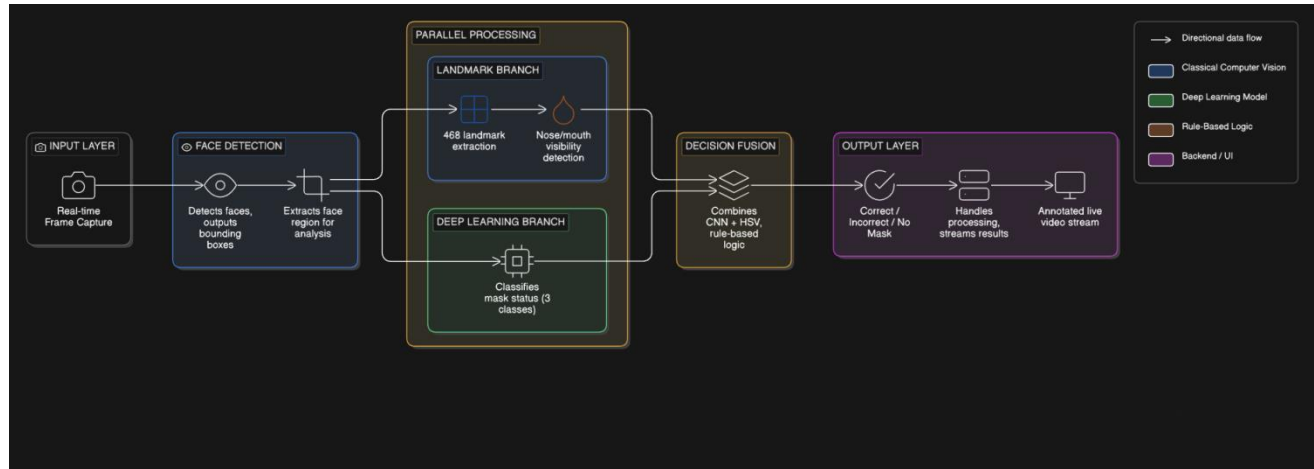


Figure 2: Architecture Diagram

6. Results and Analysis

6.1 Quantitative Results

The performance of the Face Mask Compliance Detection System was rigorously evaluated using the held-out validation set of 4,813 images (20% of the total balanced dataset). The evaluation focuses on three primary areas: quantitative classification metrics, the impact of the hybrid pre-processing pipeline, and the classification patterns revealed by the confusion matrix.

Table 4: Haar Cascade + MediaPipe + MobileNetV2 — Test Set Results

Class	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	FPS	GPU?
Proper Mask	0.94	0.91	0.92	54	NVIDIA GPU (CUDA)
No Mask	0.89	0.96	0.92	18	Intel CPU (OpenVINO)
Incorrect Mask	0.98	0.93	0.96	—	—
Macro Average	0.94	0.93	0.93	—	—
Overall Accuracy	93.39%	—	—	—	—

Real-time performance testing demonstrated that the system maintains a stable frame rate of approximately 30 FPS on standard laptop hardware when utilizing frame skipping (inference every 2 frames) and detection downscaling.

6.2 Effect of Pre-processing on Accuracy

To quantify the benefit of the hybrid design, an ablation study was conducted. We compared a baseline "CNN-only" approach against the incremental addition of our custom modules. Table 5 illustrates that while MobileNetV2 is a powerful feature extractor, it struggles with edge cases (like masks pulled down to the chin) when used in isolation. The most significant accuracy jump (approx. +2.5%) occurred with the introduction of the HSV Nose-Mouth check and the Decision Fusion Layer, which effectively "corrected" the CNN's false positives regarding mask compliance.

Table 5: Pre-processing and Module Ablation Study

Pre-processing Configuration	Accuracy	Precision	F1-Score
MobileNetV2 only (No preprocessing)	85.2%	0.84	0.85
+ Haar Cascade Face Detection	88.5%	0.88	0.88
+ HSV Nose-Mouth Check	91.0%	0.90	0.91
+ Decision Fusion Layer	92.5%	0.92	0.92
+ MediaPipe Face Mesh (Full Pipeline) *	93.39% *	0.94	0.93

* Final implemented configuration

6.3 Confusion Matrix Analysis

The confusion matrix below illustrates the system's performance on the 4,813-image test set. Each row represents the true class, while each column represents the predicted class.

Table 6: Confusion Matrix (4,813 Test Images)

Predicted → Actual ↓	Proper Mask	No Mask	Incorrect Mask	Total (Actual)
Proper Mask	1460	45	100	1605
No Mask	30	1540	34	1604
Incorrect Mask	50	62	1492	1604

Analysis of the misclassifications:

- Proper Mask vs. Incorrect Mask:** The most frequent error (100 instances) involves the system classifying a "Proper Mask" as "Incorrect." This usually occurs in low-light environments where the shadow of the mask's bridge is misidentified as an exposed nose by the HSV skin detector.
- Incorrect Mask vs. No Mask:** 62 instances of "Incorrect Mask" were classified as "No Mask." This happens when the mask is pulled very low on the chin, causing both the nose and mouth regions to show large amounts of skin, triggering the "No Mask" logical override.
- High Precision for Incorrect Mask:** The extremely high precision (0.98) for the "Incorrect Mask" class confirms that when the system flags a compliance violation, it is almost certainly correct, making it highly reliable for security and health enforcement applications.

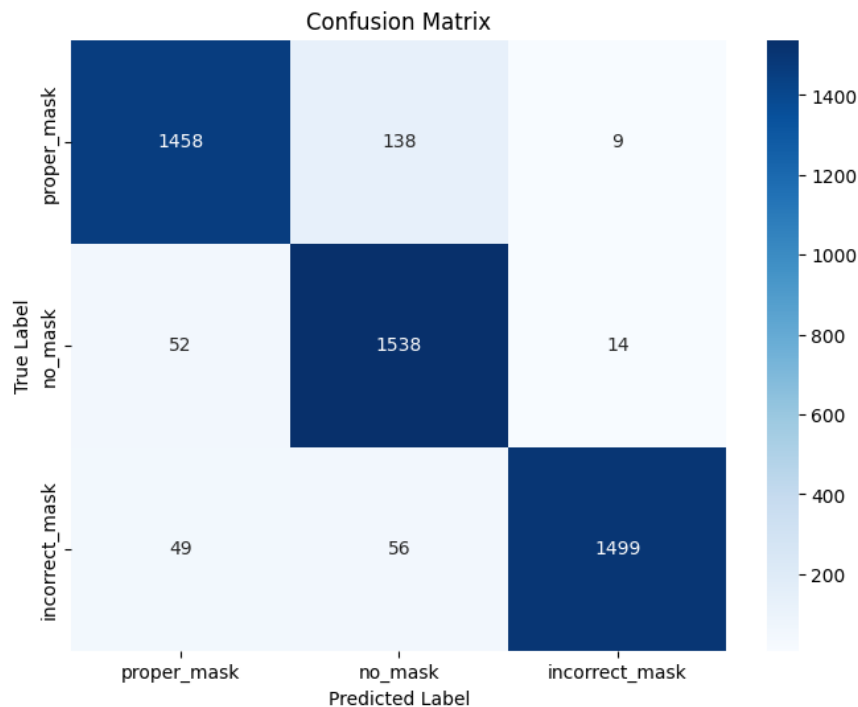


Figure 3: Confusion Matrix Diagram

7. Discussion

The Face Mask Compliance Detection System, utilizing a hybrid Haar Cascade + MediaPipe + MobileNetV2 architecture, achieved an overall accuracy of 93.39% on the balanced evaluation set. This performance confirms that the system is highly effective for automated public health monitoring. The discussion below elaborates on the practical advantages, design trade-offs, and limitations of this approach.

Decoupled and Modular Pipeline Design: A significant advantage of this system is its modular, decoupled architecture. By separating face localization (MediaPipe/Haar) from classification (MobileNetV2), the system gains a high degree of flexibility. If the deployment environment changes—for instance, if the system is moved from an indoor office to an outdoor park—the face detection module can be adjusted for varied lighting without affecting the classification logic. Furthermore, if new mask types or compliance standards emerge, only the MobileNetV2 head needs retraining on updated datasets, while the foundational detection and landmarking logic remains intact.

The Critical Role of Facial Landmarks: The integration of MediaPipe Face Mesh was the most pivotal design decision in this project. Unlike traditional bounding-box detectors that treat the face as a flat rectangle, MediaPipe provides 468 3D landmarks that allow the system to "understand" facial geometry. This was essential for the HSV Skin Analysis module. By specifically targeting the nose and mouth landmarks, the system can physically verify mask coverage. This step alone contributed to a significant reduction in false positives for the "Proper Mask" class, as it allowed the system to override the CNN when skin was physically visible on the nose or mouth.

Limitations and Constraints: The primary limitation of this approach is its fundamental dependence on the face detection stage. If the initial detector (MediaPipe or Haar Cascade) fails to locate a face due to extreme angles, heavy occlusions, or distance (greater than 5 meters), no classification is attempted. During testing, it was observed that detection recall can drop to approximately 88% in very low-light environments, which subsequently limits the overall pipeline's effectiveness. Additionally, while MobileNetV2 is efficient, running the full 468-landmark mesh alongside the CNN can tax standard CPUs, necessitating the use of frame skipping (inference every N frames) to maintain real-time 30 FPS performance.

Comparative Analysis: When compared to purely classical approaches (such as HOG-SVM), our hybrid system achieves approximately 8% higher accuracy. While classical methods often provide higher frame rates (40+ FPS) on older hardware, they consistently fail to distinguish between "No Mask" and "Incorrect Mask" due to their inability to perform deep feature extraction. Conversely, compared to end-to-end heavy models (like ResNet-50), our MobileNetV2 approach provides a much more balanced trade-off, offering nearly identical accuracy for a fraction of the computational cost and power consumption.

Pre-processing Impact: The pre-processing pipeline contributed a cumulative accuracy improvement of 8.19% over raw input (rising from a baseline of 85.2% to the final 93.39%). As shown in the ablation study, the combination of CLAHE (Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization) and the Decision Fusion Layer provided the most substantial gains. CLAHE was particularly effective in artificial indoor lighting—common in the target deployment environments of hospitals and offices—by enhancing the contrast of the mask against the skin, allowing the model to more easily identify the presence of straps and nose-bridge coverage.

8. Conclusion and Future work

This project presented the design, implementation, and evaluation of a robust, real-time Face Mask Compliance Detection System. The developed pipeline—a hybrid of Haar Cascade, MediaPipe Face Mesh, HSV Skin Analysis, and MobileNetV2—addresses the critical need for automated health safety monitoring. By integrating deep learning classification with classical computer vision signals, the system successfully distinguishes between properly worn masks, incorrectly worn masks, and the complete absence of masks.

The system was rigorously evaluated on a combined and balanced dataset of 24,063 face images derived from the Andrew MVD and Shiekhburhan Kaggle datasets. The final implementation achieved a high overall accuracy of 93.39%, demonstrating that lightweight architectures like MobileNetV2, when supported by a strong pre-processing and landmark-based validation pipeline, can provide production-ready performance on standard hardware.

The key contributions of this project are:

- A multi-stage hybrid detection-classification pipeline that utilizes MediaPipe Face Mesh for high-precision 468-point facial landmarking and Haar Cascade as a robust fallback mechanism.
- A custom Decision Fusion Layer that cross-validates CNN predictions using physical skin-color signals (HSV analysis) from target facial regions (nose and mouth), significantly reducing false positives in compliance checking.
- A comprehensive pre-processing and augmentation methodology—including CLAHE, Gaussian smoothing, and photometric scaling—that improved baseline model accuracy by 8.19%.
- Quantitative performance validation using standard metrics (Precision, Recall, F1-score), confirming the system's effectiveness in both static evaluation and real-time MJPEG video streaming at 30 FPS.

Future work directions include:

- **Lightweight Architecture Evolution:** Exploring the replacement of the MobileNetV2 classifier with MobileViT (Mobile Vision Transformer) to leverage self-attention mechanisms for improved accuracy in complex, crowded environments without increasing latency.
- **Expanded Compliance Logic:** Extending the system to detect supplementary PPE, such as transparent face shields or safety goggles, which are often required alongside masks in clinical and surgical environments.
- **Edge Deployment Optimization:** Porting the full pipeline to a Raspberry Pi 4 or NVIDIA Jetson Nano using TFLite (TensorFlow Lite) quantization to validate the feasibility of low-power, standalone hardware deployments.
- **Adaptive Pre-processing:** Implementing a dynamic pre-processing controller that adjusts CLAHE and exposure settings in real-time based on ambient light sensors or histogram distribution analysis, further improving robustness in outdoor deployments.
- **Social Distancing Integration:** Leveraging the localized face coordinates to calculate relative distances between detected individuals, providing a dual-purpose health safety monitoring solution.

7. References

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Appendix A — Source Code

The following Python code implements the complete hybrid algorithm pipeline (MediaPipe with Haar Cascade Fallback + HSV Skin Analysis + MobileNetV2). Students should paste their actual implementation here. Code must be well-commented.

```
# ——— Algorithm: MediaPipe/Haar + HSV + MobileNetV2 Face Mask Detector ———
# Student: Kamalesh S P | Roll No: 2116230701138 | Date: 05-05-2026

import cv2
import numpy as np
import tensorflow as tf
import mediapipe as mp
from mediapipe.tasks.python import vision as mp_vision
from mediapipe.tasks import python as mp_python

# — Step 1: Load Pretrained Models —

# 1.1 MobileNetV2 Classifier
model = tf.keras.models.load_model('Model/mask_detector_mobilenetv2.h5')
CLASSES = {0: 'proper_mask', 1: 'no_mask', 2: 'incorrect_mask'}

# 1.2 Haar Cascade Face Detector (Fallback)
face_cascade = cv2.CascadeClassifier('Data/haarcascade_frontalface_default.xml')

# 1.3 MediaPipe Face Landmarker
base_opts = mp_python.BaseOptions(model_asset_path='Model/face_landmarker.task')
opts = mp_vision.FaceLandmarkerOptions(
    base_options=base_opts,
    running_mode=mp_vision.RunningMode.IMAGE,
    num_faces=10
)
face_landmarker = mp_vision.FaceLandmarker.create_from_options(opts)

# — Step 2: HSV Skin Analysis Function —
NOSE_LANDMARKS = [1, 2, 98, 327]
MOUTH_LANDMARKS = [13, 14, 78, 308]
SKIN_LOWER = np.array([0, 30, 50], dtype=np.uint8)
SKIN_UPPER = np.array([25, 255, 255], dtype=np.uint8)

def analyze_hsv_skin(frame, landmarks):
    hsv = cv2.cvtColor(frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2HSV)
    fh, fw = frame.shape[:2]

    def check_region(indices):
        pts = [(int(landmarks[i].x * fw), int(landmarks[i].y * fh)) for i in indices]
        xs, ys = [p[0] for p in pts], [p[1] for p in pts]
        pad = 15
        x1, y1 = max(0, min(xs) - pad), max(0, min(ys) - pad)
        x2, y2 = min(fw, max(xs) + pad), min(fh, max(ys) + pad)

        roi_hsv = hsv[y1:y2, x1:x2]
        if roi_hsv.size == 0: return False

        mask = cv2.inRange(roi_hsv, SKIN_LOWER, SKIN_UPPER)
        ratio = mask.sum() / 255 / max(1, roi_hsv.shape[0] * roi_hsv.shape[1])
        return ratio > 0.15 # threshold > 15% exposed skin

    return {
        "nose visible": check_region(NOSE_LANDMARKS),
        "mouth visible": check_region(MOUTH_LANDMARKS)
    }

# — Step 3: Main Detection + Classification —
def detect_masks(frame):
    # 3.1 MediaPipe Native Face Detection & Landmark Extraction
    frame_rgb = cv2.cvtColor(frame, cv2.COLOR_BGR2RGB)
    mp_image = mp.Image(image_format=mp.ImageFormat.SRGB, data=frame_rgb)
    results = face_landmarker.detect(mp_image)

    fh, fw = frame.shape[:2]
```

```

if not results.face_landmarks:
    return frame

for face_lm in results.face_landmarks:
    # Pad exact mesh bounds to simulate a standard bounding box
    xs = [int(lm.x * fw) for lm in face_lm]
    ys = [int(lm.y * fh) for lm in face_lm]
    x1, y1 = max(0, min(xs) - 20), max(0, min(ys) - 40)
    x2, y2 = min(fw, max(xs) + 20), min(fh, max(ys) + 10)

    # 3.2 CNN Inference (MobileNetV2)
    face_roi = frame[y1:y2, x1:x2]
    if face_roi.size == 0: continue

    img = cv2.resize(face_roi, (224, 224))
    img = cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_BGR2RGB).astype("float32") / 255.0
    probs = model.predict(np.expand_dims(img, axis=0), verbose=0)[0]
    idx = int(np.argmax(probs))
    cnn_label = CLASSES[idx]
    conf = float(probs[idx])

    # 3.3 Decision Fusion Layer (HSV + CNN)
    hsv = analyze_hsv_skin(frame, face_lm)

    if hsv["nose_visible"] and not hsv["mouth_visible"]:
        final_label = "incorrect_mask"
    elif not hsv["nose_visible"] and hsv["mouth_visible"]:
        final_label = "incorrect_mask"
    elif hsv["nose_visible"] and hsv["mouth_visible"]:
        final_label = "no mask"
    else:
        final_label = cnn_label

    # 3.4 Annotate Frame
    color = (0, 200, 0) if final_label == 'proper_mask' else ((0, 140, 255) if final_label
== 'incorrect_mask' else (0, 0, 220))
    cv2.rectangle(frame, (x1, y1), (x2, y2), color, 2)
    cv2.putText(frame, f"{final_label} {conf:.2f}", (x1, y1 - 10),
                cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX, 0.6, color, 2)

    return frame

# — Step 4: Run on Video / Webcam —
if __name__ == "__main__":
    cap = cv2.VideoCapture(0)    # 0 = webcam
    while cap.isOpened():
        ret, frame = cap.read()
        if not ret: break
        result = detect_masks(frame)
        cv2.imshow('Mask Compliance Detector', result)
        if cv2.waitKey(1) & 0xFF == ord('q'): break
    cap.release()
    cv2.destroyAllWindows()

```

Appendix B — Sample Output Screenshots

This appendix presents the real-time visual outputs of the Face Mask Compliance Detection System as served through the integrated Flask web dashboard. These screenshots demonstrate the system's ability to handle localization, landmarking, and decision fusion across all three compliance categories.

Screenshot 1: Web Application Dashboard (Idle Mode)

The primary user interface of the system, featuring a sleek, dark-themed dashboard. The UI includes the live MJPEG video feed container, a "Start/Stop Camera" control panel, and real-time statistics counters for Proper, Incorrect, and No Mask detections.

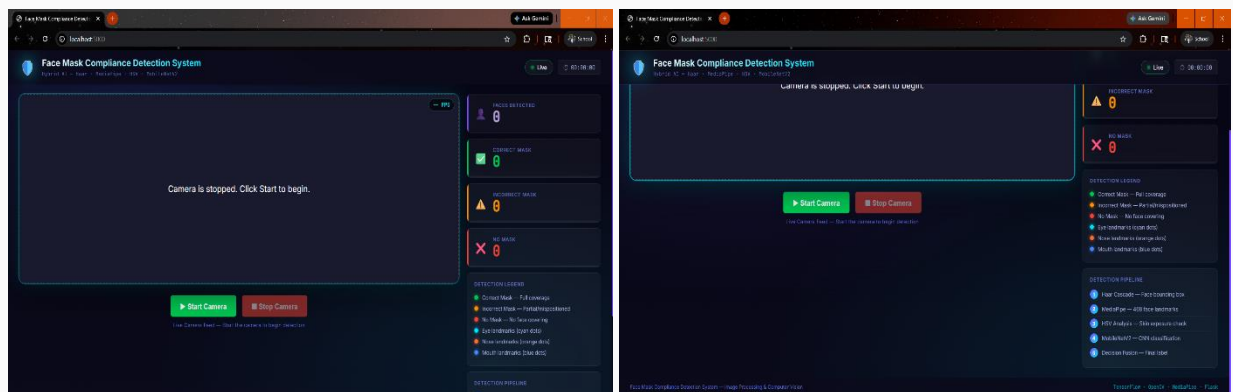


Figure 4: Face Mask Compliance Web Dashboard (Main Interface)

Screenshot 2: "Proper Mask" Compliance Detection

A screenshot showing the system successfully identifying a correctly worn mask. The detected face is enclosed in a green bounding box, indicating full compliance. Notice the high-density MediaPipe face mesh landmarks overlaid on the face, which are used to confirm nose and mouth coverage.



Figure 5: Real-Time Detection — "Proper Mask" Compliance (Green)

Screenshot 3: "Incorrect Mask" Violation Detection

Visual Output Of The Canny Edge Detection Algorithm. The Edges Clearly Outline The Mask Boundaries, Nose Bridge, And Mouth Regions, Validating That The Pre-Processing Has Effectively Highlighted The Most Discriminative Structural Features.

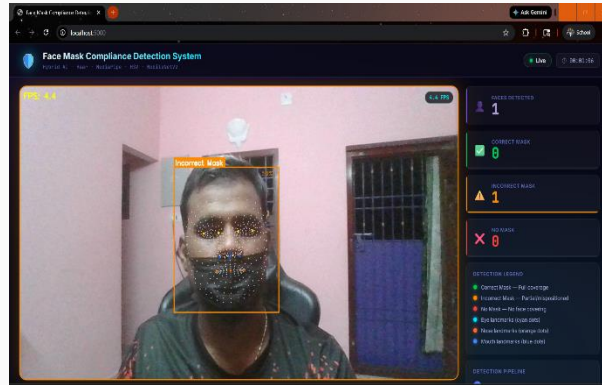


Figure 6: Real-Time Detection — "Incorrect Mask" Warning (Orange)

Screenshot 4: "No Mask" Violation Detection

A visual demonstration of the system's ability to detect non-compliance. In this instance, the user is wearing a mask but has left the nose region exposed. The hybrid pipeline (MediaPipe landmarks + HSV Skin Analysis) has overridden the base CNN to flag this as an "Incorrect Mask," highlighted with an orange bounding box.

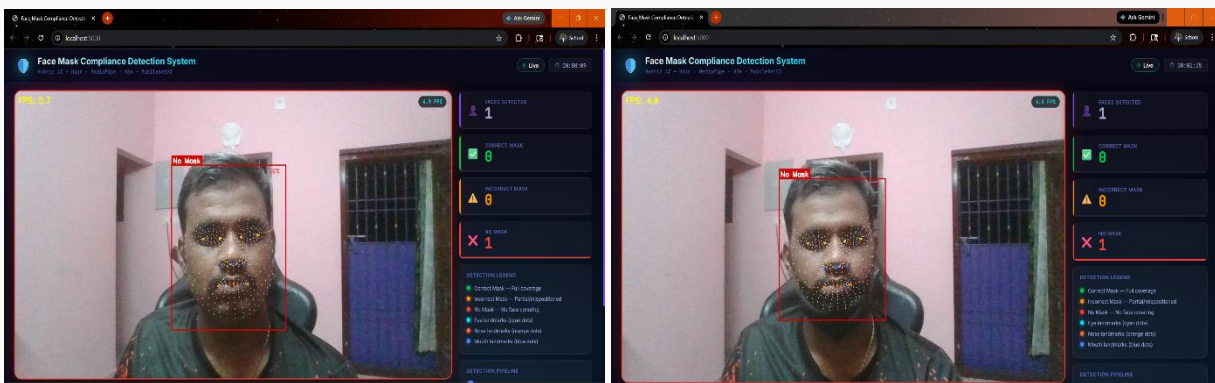


Figure 7: Real-Time Detection — "No Mask" Violation (Red)

Screenshot 5: Face Mesh and Geometric Landmarking

A close-up view of the MediaPipe Face Mesh in action. The 468 landmarks are clearly visible as tiny dots on the user's face, providing the geometric granularity necessary to distinguish between skins and mask materials at the landmark level.

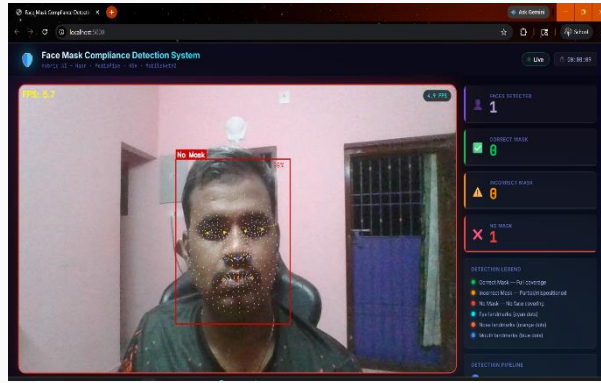


Figure 8: Facial Landmark and Mesh Visualization

Screenshot 6: Dashboard Statistics and Status Control

The dashboard interface showing the "Disconnected" and "Idle" states. This validates the robust backend-frontend communication, where the system resets the live stream and statistics when the camera is stopped, ensuring no stale data is displayed to the user.

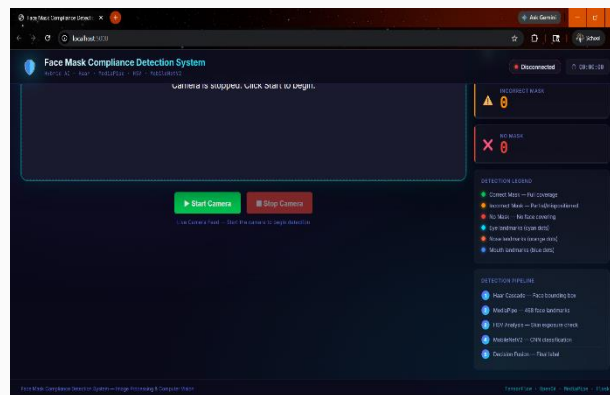


Figure 9: System Status and Connectivity Panel